

FY26 Annual Fire Q&A

1. How many elevators are in each building?

The total number of elevators that require CAT-1 safety inspection under the resulting contract is currently 25. The Contractor shall verify quantities during site investigation.

2. Is elevator recall included in this bid?

Yes. Elevator recall interface testing associated with the fire alarm system is included in the scope of work. Coordination with the elevator maintenance contractor and building operations staff shall be the responsibility of the Contractor.

3. Regarding the dry pipe sprinkler systems, please provide the date of the last full-flow trip test for each dry pipe valve in Buildings A, B, C, and D. We need to know when each system last a full-flow trip test had so we can determine which years the 3-year test will fall due across the base and option years.

The previous full flow trip test completed in August 2024. The record of previous inspections and testing, including last full-flow trip test dates, will be made available to the successful offeror upon notice to proceed. In the absence of documentation, the Contractor shall assume systems are due and include required testing in accordance with NFPA 25. Scheduling shall account for base and option year compliance requirements.

4. Does the project manager have to be full-time, or can they be a part of the working team on site?

The Project Manager may be part of the working team, provided all contractual responsibilities are met without impact to performance. The Project Manager shall be dedicated to the project and responsible for overall coordination, scheduling, reporting and quality control.

5. Section 5.2 references verifying fire pump and jockey pump start and stop pressures 'during weekly pump runs.' Please clarify whether weekly pump runs are within the contractor's scope of work, or whether this task is performed by GPO personnel and the contractor is only required to verify pressure settings during the annual inspection.

The Contractor is not responsible for conducting weekly runs. The Contractor shall verify fire pump and jockey pump start/stop pressures during the required annual inspection & testing activities compliance with NFPA 25.

6. On the retests after repairs, are we testing the full system again or just the area of the deficiency repair?

Retesting shall be limited to the affected systems or components where deficiencies were identified and corrected, in accordance with NFPA 25 requirements. Full system retesting is only required where repairs impact system-wide performance or where otherwise directed by the Contracting Officer.

7. Volume 2 requires “at least three projects of similar complexity” and Volume 4 requires at least three (3) but not more than five (5) relevant projects. Please confirm that past performance need only be detailed in Volume 4 and referenced in Volume 2.

Confirmed. These are two separate requirements. The references in Volume 2 addresses technical capability.

8. Given the proposal is meant to be submitted as a PDF portfolio, please confirm the 50-page limit applies to Volume 2 or the entire submission as a whole.

The page limit will be increased to 75 pages as part of the follow-on amendment and applies to the entire submission. Title pages and tables of content are not included in the page count.

9. If the 50-page limit applies to the entire portfolio, please confirm that personnel resumes, drawings, sample reports, sample safety plans, and copies of certifications/licenses are included in the page count or not.

Except for title pages and tables of content, the increased 75-page limit applies to everything.

10. L.2 states that complete proposals must be submitted in Adobe PDF portfolio format, but other acceptable attachments can consist of Microsoft Word, Excel or regular PDF attachments. Please confirm which are acceptable.

An Adobe portfolio is not a single PDF file. Adobe PDF portfolios serve as a container for multiple file formats (e.g. PDFs, Microsoft Word, and Microsoft Excel), as indicated in the Section L instructions. Instructions on how to create a portfolio may be found online.

11. M.1.d. states that the government intends to award resulting from this solicitation to the responsible offeror whose proposal represents best value to the government. However, M.3. states the basis of award will be based on lowest price technically acceptable. Please clarify which it is.

Best value is not limited to award based on tradeoffs. For this solicitation, the proposal that is determined the lowest priced technically acceptable (LPTA) will be considered best value to the government.

12. The RFP requires an annual inspection and testing of the sprinkler system. Per NFPA 25, sprinkler systems should be tested quarterly, semi-annually, and annually, and the activities for semi-annual and quarterly are different. Please confirm the required testing periodicity of the sprinkler system.

The intent of this contract is to provide annual inspection and testing services. The Contractor shall perform all annual NFPA 25 required inspections, testing and maintenance activities under this contract. Quarterly and semi-annual inspections are not included in the base scope. The Contractor shall identify and report any observed deficiencies related to non-performed periodic inspections.

13. The RFP requires us to use NFPA codes for this scope of work. Per NFPA 72 2025, fire alarm systems should be inspected on an annual and semi-annual basis. The current SOW requires only annual fire alarm inspection and testing. Please confirm if semi-annual fire alarm inspection and part of the current SOW, in addition to annual, and if we should price accordingly.

The current scope of work requires annual fire alarm system inspection and testing only. Semi-annual inspections are not included in the base contract scope of work and shall not be priced unless added via contract modification. All testing shall comply with applicable NFPA 72 requirements for annual inspection and testing.

14. Section C.4.0 states that the latest adopted editions of NFPA will be required; however, it is unclear which editions have been adopted by GPO. Please clarify which code year of NFPA is required.

The Contractor shall comply with the latest adopted editions of NFPA codes as enforced by the Authority Having Jurisdiction (AHJ) for this facility at the time of contract award. In general, contractors should anticipate compliance with recently adopted NFPA standards (2019-2022 editions) unless otherwise directed.

15. Are escorts required and if so, how many escorts will be available to escort at the same time?

Escort requirements will be determined based on the work area and security level. Escorts may be required in certain areas (Building D). The Government will make reasonable efforts to provide escorts; however, the Contractor shall coordinate scheduling in advance. Work sequencing may be required.

16. Will the customer provide subcontractors for the interconnected systems, to assist with testing (Ex. Elevator, HVAC, generator, etc.)? If so, who is responsible for coordinating scheduling with these subcontractors, the customer of the awarded offeror?

The Government may provide access to existing service contractors for interconnected systems. The Contractor shall be responsible for coordinating all scheduling and testing activities with these parties to ensure complete system integration testing.

17. Is there any cost associated with the background check and fingerprinting for the technicians?

All required background checks and fingerprinting shall be coordinated through the Government. Any associated costs shall be by the Contractor and included in the proposal.

18. Please advise if there are any safety or environmental hazards in any of the facilities.

The facilities are active, occupied federal buildings. Contractors should anticipate typical operational hazards. Asbestos and lead are environmental hazards known at this time. The Contractor shall comply with all applicable OSHA, NFPA, and site-specific safety requirements. The Contractor shall perform their own hazard assessment prior to execution of work.

19. What is the cost associated with purchasing a GPO complex parking pass for contractor vehicles?

GPO offers parking in Lot 50 at rate of \$9 per day. Parking is limited at the GPO complex. If parking passes are required, any associated costs shall not be charged to the contract. Specific details regarding availability and pricing will be provided upon award.

20. Is there any fee associated with the submittal of the inspection reports to the Fire Marshall's office that the contractor will be responsible for?

There are no known fees associated with submission of inspection reports. All administrative and coordination efforts shall be included in the Contractor's proposal.

21. Do the sprinkler test points require routing or capturing of water discharged during testing, or are the test points already outside?

The Contractor shall assume that some test points will require routing or capture of discharged water. The Contractor is responsible for providing all necessary hoses, drainage, and protection measures to prevent damage.

22. What is the contract value for incumbent contractors?

The incumbent contract, 040DV25P0448, was awarded to HurtVet Subcontracting, LLC for a one-year period from 1 June 2025 to 31 May 2026. It was valued at \$78,670 for similar, but not exact services.

23. Please confirm whether a lift or any special access equipment is required to reach fire alarm devices, sprinkler components, or other life-safety equipment.

The Contractor shall provide all necessary access equipment (lifts, ladders, etc.) required to safely access all system components.

24. What is the specific time frame during which we are permitted to perform the audio-visual testing and elevator testing?

Testing that impacts building occupants or operations shall be conducted during Government approved times, which may include evenings or weekends. Scheduling shall be coordinated with the COR.

25. The RFP mentions that certain tasks may require work outside normal business hours. Please specify which tasks may require work outside normal hours.

Work outside normal business hours may be required for activities that could disrupt operations i.e. audible fire alarm testing, elevator recall testing, fire pump flow testing, etc.

26. Please confirm whether as-built drawings, sequence of operation, record of completion will be made available to the awarded offeror.

Available documentation, including as-builts will be provided to the extent available.

27. Please confirm whether prior inspection report for sprinkler wet, pre-action, dry system and fire pump will be made available.

Yes. Prior inspection and testing reports will be made available if on file.

28. If there are duct detectors that are not monitored but activate dampers, shall the contractor include testing of unmonitored duct detectors?

Yes. The Contractor shall test all duct detectors, including those not monitored by the fire alarm system, where they perform a life-safety or control function, in accordance with NFPA requirements.

29. If there is an existing Halon system, is this system monitored by the fire alarm system? If yes, is the contractor responsible for testing the Halon system as well?

Yes, there is an existing Halon system. If a Halon or clean agent system is interfaced with the fire alarm system, the Contractor shall test system interfaces. Full discharge testing not required unless specifically directed.

30. Will deficiencies of the fire alarm system be addressed by the in-house GPO fire alarm shop? If no, will addressing and repairing deficiencies be the responsibility of the contractor?

This contract is for inspection and testing only. Deficiency corrections will be performed by the Government or others unless otherwise authorized. The Contractor shall document all deficiencies.

31. Does GPO have a suppression/special hazard system on-site protecting spaces not disclosed?

No.

32. How many sets of elevators are there in total for the scope of this project?

See previous response.

33. How many floors do the elevators cover?

Elevators serve multiple levels, including basement and upper floors. Field verification is required. Buildings A, B, C include a basement thru 8th floor. Building D has basement thru 3rd floor.

34. Is there a security clearance requirement for onsite personnel?

Formal security clearances are not required; however, all personnel must complete background checks and badging requirements prior to site access. Escorts may be required in certain areas.

35. Is there any site-specific training required? If yes, how long does it take?

No. Site-specific training is not required prior to performing work. The Contractor must at a minimum support, service, inspect test all devices in the Edwards System Technology EST3 without the support of sub-contractors.

36. If manual reset is required for units, is the HVAC vendor provided during these inspections/tests?

The Government may provide access to the HVAC contractor, if necessary. However, the Contractor is responsible for coordinating all required system resets and scheduling with supporting vendors.

37. Do any of the locations have generators tied into fire alarm systems?

Where emergency generators are monitored by or provide supervisory signals to the fire alarm system, those interfaces shall be tested. Full generator operational testing is not included.

38. Is 5-year sprinkler inspections part of this scope of work? If so, when was it performed last?

Five-year sprinkler inspections are not included. Historical records will be provided if available.

39. Is fire alarm sensitivity training required as part of the scope of work?

No sensitivity training is not required as part of the annual fire alarm inspection and testing scope. All inspection, testing, and sensitivity verification shall be performed in accordance with NFPA 72.

40. Are there any pre-action systems at any of the identified locations? If yes, how may across all locations?

Yes, Building D (Basement-3rd Floor). Quantities are identified in available documentation. The Contractor shall verify during site investigation.

41. Are there any VSDAs at any of the identified locations?

No. VSDA systems are not present at any of the identified locations.

42. Are there any workstations? If yes, may GPO provide a description/list of these workstations.

The existing Edwards EST3 Fire Alarm System may include one or more workstations utilized for system monitoring, control, and event annunciation. The Contractor

shall field verify all existing EST3 network nodes and workstations during site investigation.

43. Please confirm whether a Department of Labor Wage Determination is applicable to this project.

GPO does not require wage determinations for this requirement.